
Translation Rights Royalty Statement Standard

At BISG, we know that when the publishing process is messy, standards are a great solution.

Overview

In January 2026, BISG's [Rights Committee](#) released the final update to the **Translation Rights Royalty Statement Standard**. The completed standard is ready for industry adoption and is available in [both PDF and Excel formats](#) on BISG's Knowledge Center, with the Excel version provided to support easier comparison to current publisher statements. It specifies a set of forty-four data fields which, when included in every royalty statement exchanged between licensees and licensors of translation rights, will alleviate the often confusing—and always time-consuming—process of properly allocating earnings and sales information to titles and authors. BISG is now promoting industry adoption of this standard.

Why the Standard Matters

Royalty statements are a critical piece of publishing communication. Based on committee members' experience, years of anecdotal evidence, and [a survey conducted by BISG](#), the time spent chasing missing details in order to understand, analyze, and match payments on royalty reporting is a common pain point in the rights and accounting departments of publishers and literary agencies alike. Over the past several years, a BISG Rights Committee working group has researched and defined best practices for royalty reporting. This Translation Rights Royalty Statement Standard is the outcome of this work, providing a recommended and consistent set of data points for licensors and licensees to use when reporting the results of translation rights transactions.

Scope and Stakeholders

BISG has long specialized in creating and promoting standards that improve workflows and processes in publishing. In promoting this updated standard, BISG encourages feedback from all stakeholders in the royalty statement workflow. These stakeholders include

licensees who send statements; royalty and accounting system vendors who create statements within complex software ecosystems; rightsholders who receive statements and parse them for data that is used to understand markets; and those who use royalty reporting data for financial accounting that is passed along to authors and on to company financial reporting related to profitability of titles, imprints, and overall company health.

Adoption and Participation

January 2026 marks the global release of the BISG Translation Rights Royalty Statement Standard, and broad participation is essential to its success. We invite international rights professionals to join us in becoming part of the solution. Please share steps you are taking to encourage adoption of the updated standard. Let us know how we can support collaboration—both within your organization and across your network of licensees and licensors. Improvements in this area of publishing communication will continue to build over time, with clear rewards: **less time spent wrangling data, more time focused on actionable insights, and deeper conversations about good books and good business.**

Get Involved

If you are interested in being involved in this initiative and/or have comments regarding the standard or its implementation, we'd like to hear from you. Please email info@bisg.org to share your feedback.

Let's turn pain points into progress—together.

BOOK INDUSTRY STUDY GROUP RIGHTS COMMITTEE

TRANSLATION RIGHTS ROYALTY STATEMENT STANDARD

<https://knowledgecenter.bisg.org/226a2o7/>

IDENTIFIER	DATA RELATED TO	FIELD LABEL	DESCRIPTION/SYNONYMS/BEST PRACTICE
Con1_LicName	contract	Licensee Name	Party that licensed rights and is remitting royalty statements to the Licensor. SYNONYMS: Rights Buyer; Purchaser; Translation Rights Publisher.
Con6_LicConInfo	contract	Licensee Contact Information	Full postal address, email address, website URL and phone numbers.
Con11_LicImp	contract	Licensee Imprint	Trade name under which Licensee publishes the work.
Con16_PayName	contract	Payer Name	Party responsible for making payments due under the contract. NOTE: Populate this field only if Payer Name is different from Licensee Name. For example, if Licensee is an imprint of a large company, but the Payer is the parent company, this field will show parent company name. This field is not to be used for name of bank or financial institution originating payment.
Con21_PayConInfo	contract	Payer Contact Information	Full postal address, email address, website URL and phone numbers.
Con26_LicContID	contract	Licensee Contract ID	Unique identifying code, name, or reference used in Licensee records/systems that distinguishes the contract that is connected to the royalty statement, usually auto-generated by a system/database. SYNONYMS: Contract Number; Contract Reference.
Con31_LicensorName	contract	Licensor Name	Name of the rightsholder (the entity granting the rights) for this contract. SYNONYMS: Rights Seller; Proprietor.
Con36_LicensorContID	contract	Licensor Contract ID	Unique identifying code, name, or reference used in Licensor records/systems that distinguishes the contract that is connected to the royalty statement, usually auto-generated by a system/database. SYNONYMS: Contract Number; Contract Reference.
Con41_ContribNames	contract	Contributor Name(s)	Name(s) of the creator(s) of the work being licensed, such as Author/Illustrator/Series editor, etc. BEST PRACTICE: Identify contributors using their ISNI numbers.
Con46_LicensorWorkTitle	contract	Licensor Title of Work	Title of the work as published by the Licensor. NOTE: Any preliminary title used in contract must be updated to match Licensor's final published title.
Con51_LicWorkTitle	contract	Licensee Title of Work	Title of work as published by the Licensee. NOTE: Licensee's title of the work is not necessarily a literal translation of the Licensor's title.
Con56_LangLicWork	contract	Language of Licensee Work	Specific language of Licensee's translated work. NOTE: Some contracts grant Licensee the right to publish in more than one language.
Con61_SalesTerr	contract	Sales Territory	Geographic areas where Licensee's edition has been sold. NOTE: Contract will sometimes specify royalty rates tied to generic territories such as "home," or "export" -- and the contract will contain detailed definitions. SYNONYMS: Sales Region; Market.
Con66_AdvAmount	contract	Advance Amount	Amount of money paid by Licensee to Licensor prior to any royalty earnings. NOTE: Amounts and payment schedules are specified in the contract. An advance may be payable in several installments. Statement includes the total amount of advances paid up to the period end date of the statement, including any refresher advances. SYNONYMS: Minimum Guarantee.
Con71_AdvCurr	contract	Advance Currency	Monetary currency of the advance (i.e. \$, €, £, ¥ or USC, EUR, GBP, CNY etc.). NOTE: Advance Amount (ID #Con66) is a numeral.

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SS2_RoyStmntDate	statement specific	Royalty Statement Date	Date the royalty statement was generated.
SS7_RoyRptStartDt	statement specific	Royalty Reporting Period Start Date	Start date of the royalty reporting period.
SSI2_RoyRptEndDt	statement specific	Royalty Reporting Period End Date	End date of the royalty reporting period.
SSI7_OpenBal	statement specific	Opening Balance	Any negative (or unearned) amount listed as Closing Balance on prior period statement. If a payment was made in prior period, Opening Balance for this period is '0'. SYNONYMS: Balance Forward.
SS22_NetUnitsToBegPer	statement specific	Net Units Sold to Beginning of Period	Number of copies listed as Life to Date Sales on prior period statement. BEST PRACTICE: List quantities sold for each product form.
SS27_LicProdIdentifier	statement specific	Licensee Product Identifier	A product number. For books, must be ISBN; for non-book products for which ISBNs are unavailable or inappropriate, then alternate identifiers are acceptable.
SS32_ProdFormDtl	statement specific	Product Form Detail	Physical or digital format of a product, i.e. hardcover, paperback, e-book, audiobook, etc. SYNONYMS: Product Format; Product Type; Edition Format.
SS37_LicPubDate	statement specific	Licensee Publication Date	Date that the Licensee's work was made available for sale. BEST PRACTICE: List publication date for each product form.
SS42_LicListPrice	statement specific	Licensee List Price	Licensee's price to the consumer. Often a calculation factor for royalties on copies sold through trade channels in home territories. BEST PRACTICE: Include List Price for each product form. SYNONYMS: Recommended Retail Price; Published Price; Catalog Price; Cover Price.
SS47_RoyRate	statement specific	Royalty Rate	Percentage per copy or amount per copy to be paid by Licensee to Licensor, used as a calculation factor in the final equation for Royalty Earnings. NOTE: Include rate escalations, if contract specifies.
SS52_RoyBasis	statement specific	Royalty Basis	Second calculation factor used in the final equation for Royalty Earnings to Licensor for Licensee sales, typically list price, net sales amount, net receipts, etc.
SS57_UnitsSoldInPer	statement specific	Units Sold in Period	Number of copies sold by the Licensee per product form, to be used as a factor in calculating Royalty Earnings to Licensor. NOTE: Returns will show as negative numbers.
SS62_RoyEarnings	statement specific	Royalty Earnings	Resulting amount of the calculation of Royalty Rate x Royalty Basis x Units Sold in Period per product form.
SS67_TotRoyEarnings	statement specific	Total Royalty Earnings	Sum of all royalties earned for all product forms.
SS72_LTDUnitsSold	statement specific	Life to Date Units Sold	Sum of Units Sold in Period and Net Units Sold to Beginning of Period. SYNONYMS: Cumulative Sales.
SS77_ResWithheld	statement specific	Reserve Withheld	Monetary amount of Royalty Earnings withheld in this reporting period by the Licensee against anticipated sales returns. NOTE: Usually a flat percentage rate specified in the contract. This amount is always 0 or a negative number. SYNONYMS: Reserve Against Returns; Reserve For Returns.
SS82_ResReleased	statement specific	Reserve Released	Monetary amount of Reserve Withheld in a previous period being released in this reporting period. This amount is always 0 or a positive number. SYNONYMS: Refunded Reserve; Prior Returns Reserve Released.
SS87_ClosingBal	statement specific	Closing Balance	Sum of Total Royalty Earnings, any Reserve Withheld or Reserve Released and any Licensor Amount of Sublicense Income in this period.
SS92_PayDue	statement specific	Payment Due	Sum of the Opening Balance and Closing Balance. Will show UNEARNED (negative number) where sum of earnings is less than Opening Balance; or EARNED (positive number) if sum is greater than Opening Balance.
SC3_SubLicName	statement specific-conditional	Sublicensee Name (if applicable)	Name of entity which acquired subsidiary rights from Licensee.
SC8_SubLicType	statement specific-conditional	Sublicense Type (if applicable)	Identifies the type of subsidiary right sublicensed by Licensee and on which income is payable to the Licensor.
SC13_SubLicIncome	statement specific-conditional	Sublicense Income (if applicable)	Full amount of income received by Licensee from each sublicensee in the reporting period.
SC18_LicensorShare	statement specific-conditional	Licensor Share of Sublicense Income (if applicable)	Percentage to be paid to Licensor of Licensee's receipts from each sublicensee. SYNONYMS: Split of Sublicense Monies.
SC23_LicensorAmtInc	statement specific-conditional	Licensor Amount of Sublicense Income (if applicable)	Monetary amount due to Licensor of Licensee's receipts from each sublicensee.

IDENTIFIER	DATA RELATED TO	FIELD LABEL	DESCRIPTION/SYNONYMS/BEST PRACTICE
RA4_RemitIDInfo	remittance advice	ID Information	BEST PRACTICE: Include Licensor Contract ID, Contributor Name(s) and Licensor Title of Work on remittance paperwork for easier matching of payment to contract.
RA9_CoAgentCommPerc	remittance advice	Co-Agent Commission Percentage (if applicable)	BEST PRACTICE: Show the percentage and monetary amount for agency commission being deducted as payment to the local co-agent on the contract.
RA14_LicTaxID	remittance advice	Licensee VAT/tax identification number	BEST PRACTICE: Show Licensee VAT numbers on remittances paperwork. NOTE: All invoices sent to Licensees in European Union require use of Licensee VAT.
RA19_LicensorTaxExStatus	remittance advice	Licensor Tax Exemption Status	BEST PRACTICE: Indicate the tax exemption status of the Licensor in the country of the Licensee. Choices: not applicable; waived; expiry date.
RA24_LicensorTaxHeldAmt	remittance advice	Licensor Tax Withheld Amount	BEST PRACTICE: Show the percentage and monetary amount for any foreign income tax being deducted from Payment Due.